Apple Review Rejection: Root Cause & Compliance Solution

Architectural specification for transitioning digital ticketing and creator tips from Stripe to Direct Native Apple StoreKit.

1. Problem Root Cause: Why Apple Rejected Stripe

Apple strictly classifies commercial transactions into **Physical Goods/Services** and **Digital Content/Services**. In VibeSwipe, both primary monetization flows are purely digital goods consumed directly on an iOS device:

MONETIZATION FEATURE	TRANSACTION CLASSIFICATION	PREVIOUS SETUP	APPLE MANDATE
Live Performance Ticket	Unlocks live broadcast inside iOS app	Stripe Sheet	**Apple In-App Purchase (StoreKit) Only**
Super Chat & Creator Tip	Digital donation & highlighted message in stream	Stripe Sheet	**Apple In-App Purchase (Consumable) Only**
Physical Merch / Concert (if applicable)	Delivered or attended in physical real world	Stripe Sheet	**Stripe / External Gateway Permitted**

Apple Review Guideline 3.1.1 — Strict Mandate

"If you want to unlock features or functionality within your app (e.g. access to premium content, virtual tipping, broadcasts), you must use in-app purchase. Apps offering real-time one-to-many services (such as live stream broadcasts) must use in-app purchase."

Impact on VibeSwipe: Stripe cannot be used on iOS for these digital features under any circumstance. Apple takes a mandatory 15%–30% platform fee on all digital transactions. Any iOS build presenting Stripe checkout for digital goods is automatically rejected.

2. The Technical Constraint: Dynamic Pricing vs. Fixed SKUs

Why an architectural update is necessary when transitioning from Stripe to Apple:

- **Stripe Open Model (Dynamic Amounts):** Allows any runtime float (e.g. an artist sets a ticket at `$4.75` or a user types an arbitrary tip of `$12.30`). Stripe charges arbitrary values on demand.
- **Apple StoreKit Model (Predefined Fixed SKUs):** Apple **does not provide an arbitrary/dynamic pricing API**. Every purchasable item must map to a static **Product ID (SKU)** configured in App Store Connect with an assigned **Apple Price Tier** ($0.99, $1.99, $4.99, $9.99, etc.).

Key Architectural Requirement

Neither the artist nor the listener can enter a random open decimal into Apple's payment sheet. All ticket prices and tipping options must map to **Predefined Standard Tiers**.

The Solution: Fixed-Tier Direct StoreKit Architecture

Standardizing live stream tickets and creator tips into predefined Apple SKUs (Zero 3rd-Party Fees).

3. Implementation: Standardized Tiers

A. Live Stream Performance Tickets

In `artist_go_live_setup_view.dart`, when an artist toggles **"Paid Performance"**, they select from **5 Standard Ticket Tiers**:

TICKET TIER	TICKET PRICE	APP STORE CONNECT SKU	APPLE IAP TYPE	ARTIST EARNS (NET ~70-85%)
Tier 1 (Standard)	$1.99	`com.vibeswipe.ticket.tier1`	Non-Renewing / Consumable	~$1.40 - $1.69
Tier 2 (Popular)	$4.99	`com.vibeswipe.ticket.tier2`	Non-Renewing / Consumable	~$3.50 - $4.24
Tier 3 (Premium)	$9.99	`com.vibeswipe.ticket.tier3`	Non-Renewing / Consumable	~$7.00 - $8.49
Tier 4 (VIP Pass)	$19.99	`com.vibeswipe.ticket.tier4`	Non-Renewing / Consumable	~$14.00 - $16.99
Tier 5 (Exclusive)	$49.99	`com.vibeswipe.ticket.tier5`	Non-Renewing / Consumable	~$35.00 - $42.49

B. Super Chat & Creator Tipping

In `super_chat_bottom_sheet.dart`, preset chips (`$1.99, $4.99, $9.99, $24.99, $49.99`) map directly to Apple Consumable IAPs:

TIP BADGE	AMOUNT (USD)	APP STORE CONNECT SKU	APPLE IAP TYPE	PIN DURATION
Bronze Tip	$1.99	`com.vibeswipe.tip.tier1`	Consumable	1 Min Pin
Silver Tip	$4.99	`com.vibeswipe.tip.tier2`	Consumable	3 Min Pin
Gold Tip	$9.99	`com.vibeswipe.tip.tier3`	Consumable	5 Min Pin
Platinum Tip	$24.99	`com.vibeswipe.tip.tier4`	Consumable	10 Min Pin
Diamond Tip	$49.99	`com.vibeswipe.tip.tier5`	Consumable	30 Min Pin

4. Platform Split: iOS vs. Android & Web

iOS Platform (Direct Apple StoreKit)

- **Package:** Official `in_app_purchase`
- **Zero Middleman:** Direct to Apple & Firebase ($0 fee)
- **Pricing:** Standardized Fixed Tiers (Tier 1 - 5)
- **Flow:** Native 1-Tap Face ID / Touch ID
- **Review Status:** 100% Guideline 3.1.1 Compliant

Android & Web Platform (Stripe)

- **Engine:** Existing Stripe Architecture
- **Pricing:** Dynamic / Custom Amounts Supported
- **Flow:** Stripe Payment Sheet & Web Checkout
- **Review Status:** No Google Play / Web Restrictions

5. Technical Implementation Steps

Step 1
App Store Connect Setup
Complete Tax & Banking in Developer Console. Register 5 Ticket SKUs & 5 Tip SKUs.

Step 2
Flutter Native Integration
Add official `in_app_purchase` package. Hook into native Face ID checkout.

Step 3
Firebase Verification
Pass receipt to Firebase Cloud Functions to verify and grant live stream access.